



Lovely Professional University Dynamic, Tech-savvy and Innovative

How does a truly futuristic university such as Lovely Professional University leverage technology for teaching-learning process? Read on to know



Ashok Mittal, an exponent of industry-relevant higher education, is chancellor of Lovely Professional University (LPU). He coordinates implementation of the LPU's strategic plan and is responsible for the development, formulation, coordination and communication of complex and highly sensitive policy initiatives for the university

Ashok Mittal

Lovely Professional University, Phagwara, is a rapidly growing state university in Punjab adding nearly 8000 students annually to itself, capitalising on its variety of programmes and quality infrastructure. The growing numbers at one hand epitomised the growing stature of the university but at the same time posed a serious challenge for the university in maintaining various types of data pertaining to students.

This, coupled with data of more than 1500 faculty and staff members, further complicated the programmes. The data of existing and old alumni, in combined form was assuming enormous proportions and the old way of storing data was running out of efficiency. Also, any decision of the university could affect the future of the students adversely or favourably. A wrong decision to not allow a student to sit for examination because of wrong calculation of attendance

or failing a student because of wrong calculation of result could have spoiled his whole career.

To increase the efficiency and reliability, we started looking at the option of shifting the information base to the IT-driven platform. During our preliminary search, we found out that though there were big players like SAP and Oracle who had ready packages for the education sector, all of them had been customised and aligned with respect to US education system. This put our plans on twist. But then we took a bold step to get the business process mapped to a fully customisable solution.

We started the process by adding the first module of putting the data of students during the admission process. The whole process became swift and transparent. We added various features to it including automatically generated SMS to students on admissions and enquiry. We added more modules in the whole system in another 3-4 months and took all our records to the IT-based system. Various data including students' attend-

ance records and examination marks were fed into the system, which could be accessed on real-time basis.

Retrieving information became easy not only for the staff but also for the students. Now we have to depute less of the administrative staff to provide information on students' queries related to marks, etc. All students have access to the most recent and updated information at the click of a button. A student can check his attendance, assignment, schedule, important notifications, syllabi, etc while sitting at home. Students can also submit their assignments online, saving their precious time. With this online initiative taken by the university, the system became more transparent as well as accessible.

With the students' problem having been solved, the next underlying problem was the huge human resource on which LPU was counting. The human count was as high as 1500 in the university. Timely access to staff attendance records, leave records, salaries, appraisals, joining dates, emergency